



Imperial crown

◀ PRUSSIAN GRENADIER'S CAP

Date 1713

Origin Prussia

Material Wool

This cap was worn by grenadiers in the infantry regiment of Frederick Henry, Margrave of Brandenburg-Schwedt, in 1713. At the time, Henry was just four years old and under the guardianship of his uncle, Frederick I.



▶ GRENADIER'S POUCH

Date 1750

Origin England

Material Leather, brass

Grenadiers carried leather pouches containing essential equipment for use on the battlefield. The brass facing depicts a grenadier wearing a tall cap, which made him look even more imposing to enemy forces.



Canvas belt

▶ PRUSSIAN OFFICER'S GORGET

Date 1750

Origin Prussia

Material Brass

In the 18th and 19th centuries, army officers wore gorgets – a metal collar originally designed to protect the throat – as a symbol of their rank.



Prussian coat of arms

▲ BRITISH GRENADIER'S CAP

Date 1746

Origin England

Material Wool

This cap for an officer in the Norwich Company of Artillery bears the personal coat of arms of Sir John Hobart. He raised the company in 1746 to defend the city in the event of attack during the Jacobite Rebellion.

▼ PRUSSIAN INFANTRY UNIFORM

Date 1740

Origin Prussia

Material Wool

The infantrymen in the Prussian army under Frederick II ("Frederick the Great") wore long, dark blue coats with red facings and lining. They fought with flintlock muskets and were fiercely disciplined and highly trained.

Shirt and waistcoat worn beneath coat



Uniform dyed with "Prussian blue" pigment



Red cuffs and lining

▲ MILITARY GREATCOAT OF FREDERICK THE GREAT

Date 1760

Origin Prussia

Material Wool

Frederick the Great (see p.160) often led the Prussian army in person and frequently dressed in a simple blue military uniform and greatcoat. Frederick was widely praised for his battlefield tactics – in fact, Napoleon Bonaparte regarded Frederick as the greatest military tactician in history.